Colophon

Written over, never erased.

Recording, measuring and disclosing the human and AI contribution *while* a text is written — publishing a record a reader can check, instead of a label they have to believe.

THE PROBLEM

Two ways to say how a text was made, and both fail

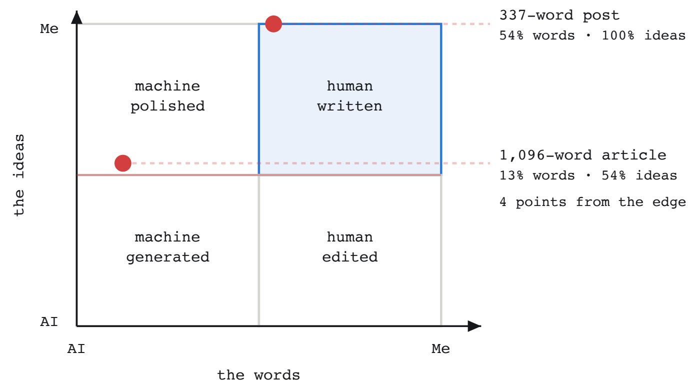
One asks a machine to guess afterwards. The other asks the author to promise. Neither survives the case that matters: a person and a model writing together.

> **39%**
>
> Detector accuracy on AI text edited by hand — 26% once paraphrased, and below chance at word level on genuinely co-written text. Difficulty peaks at about half AI contribution: the commonest case is the worst one.

> **0.1%**
>
> Papers that disclose AI use, out of more than 164,000 — while 70% of journals require it. And a text cannot prove its own authorship, so a voluntary statement is costless signalling.

THE MEASUREMENT

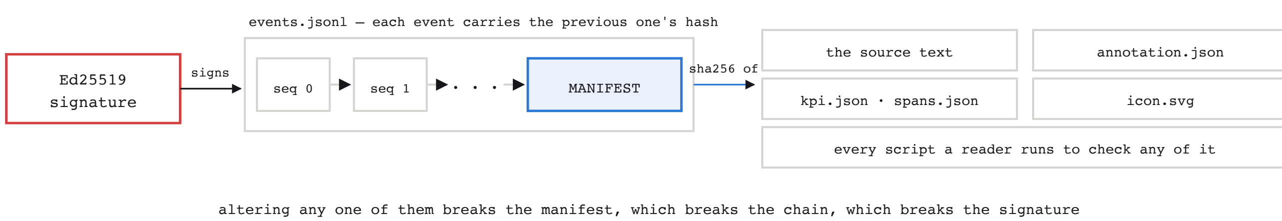
Two axes, because two texts can differ on one and not the other



Two real measurements. The first text's words are barely more than half the author's while every idea is theirs; the second is written almost entirely in the model's words and is still, narrowly, the author's thinking. One number could not have told those apart.

THE CLOSURE

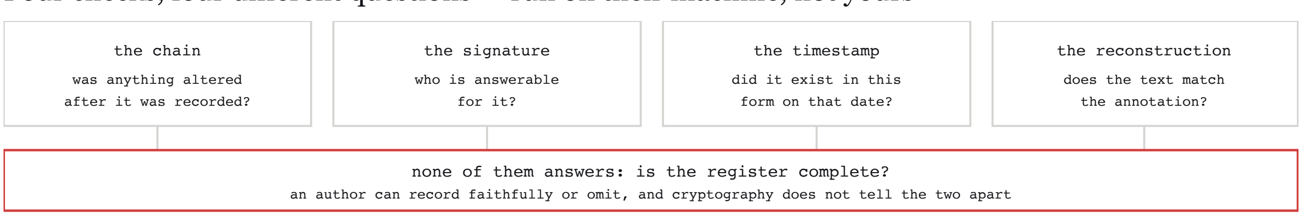
One signature, on one file, reaches the whole case



seal.sh signs one file and nothing else. What makes that a claim about the article is the last event: a manifest carrying the digest of every file the measurement depends on. Without it the text would sit outside the signature entirely, and a reader who checked it would have proved less than they think.

THE READER

Four checks, four different questions — run on their machine, not yours



The value is not in the proof. It is in the responsibility an author takes on by publishing the record, and in the fact that it can be inspected.

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